Kuratish Language

(The Kuratish) [7has Quratish]

Karl

(1) Alphabet and Pronunciation (unspecified sounds follow English pronunciation)

The first letter of sentences, all proper nouns, exclamatory particles, religious terms, and names must be capitalized.

Alphabet (uppercase/lowercase):

Aa, Bb, Dd, Ee, F⊆, G9, Hh, Ii, Jj, Kk, Ll, Mm, Nn, Oo, Pp, Qq, Rr, Ss, 7t, Uu, Ww, Yy

Vowels: a, e, i, o, u, y/iː/, ai, ae, ar, au, ay, ea, ei, er, ir, io/ioʊ/, iu/ijuː/, oa, oe, or, ou/oʊr/, ua/juːær/

Plosives: b, d, p, t, k, 9, q

Fricatives: ⊆, th, thi/z/, s, sh, ti, h, j/dʒ/, tth/tʃ/, w⊆/v/

Nasals: m, n, n9/ŋ/

Others: l/l/, r/r/, w/w/, qu/kw/

Pronunciation Rules:

Stress falls on the penultimate syllable.

When a final vowel meets a suffix vowel, they merge.

When two identical plosives meet, the first is not released; a brief pause is inserted.

When an aspirated plosive occurs between two vowels, it shifts toward a voiced sound.

When "w⊆" appears before the vowel "u" or "o," it is pronounced as /w/.

When nasal "n" or "m" precedes the plosive "d" or "b," the plosive disappears but the nasal remains.

When two vowels are directly adjacent and do not form a diphthong, they are connected by a semivowel.

(2) Syntax

Word order: SOV

Alignment type: Nominative–accusative alignment

Declarative sentence: Subject + Direct Object + Transitive Verb

Subject + linking verb + predicate

Subject + intransitive verb

Subject + indirect object + transitive verb + direct object

Subject + object + transitive verb + object complement

Questions: Auxiliary verb + declarative sentence + question marker

Linking verb + subject + predicate + question marker

Question word + subject + predicate + question marker

Question word + predicate + object + question marker

Exclamations: Declarative sentence + exclamation marker

Imperatives: Subject + predicate

Passive voice statements: Direct object + subject + transitive verb + passive marker

Indirect object + subject + transitive verb + direct object + passive marker

Object + subject + transitive verb + object complement + passive marker

Subject + transitive verb + passive marker

(3) Tense and Aspect

In Kuratish, tense and aspect are expressed by adding markers to sentences; therefore, verbs do not undergo inflection for tense or aspect.

Past tense:

Pot /pɑt/ – past marker, placed at the end of a sentence or after the predicate,

indicating that the action occurred in the past. When placed after the predicate, it can be shortened to ‘p’, pronounced as a blend with the preceding word; if the preceding word ends in a plosive sound, it becomes ’ot /ɑt/.

Nostal /ˈnɔstɑl/ – past marker, must appear at the beginning of a sentence and is separated by a comma; functions similarly to pot. Used specifically to shift the entire sentence into the past tense, but in this case must appear as En nostale /ɪn nɔˈstaː.le/, forming a standalone sentence at the beginning of a paragraph.

Future tense:

Fits /fɪts/ – future marker, placed at the end of a sentence or after the predicate, indicating that the action will occur in the future. When placed after the predicate, it can be shortened to ‘⊆’, pronounced as a blend with the preceding word; if the preceding word ends in a fricative sound, it becomes ’it /ɪt/.

Nokstal /nɔ‘kstɑl/ – future marker, must appear at the beginning of a sentence and is separated by a comma; functions similarly to fits. Used specifically to shift an entire sentence into the future tense, but in this case must appear as En nokstale /ɪn nɔksˈt ɑ.le/, forming a standalone sentence at the beginning of a paragraph.

Perfect tense:

Don /dɑŋ/ – perfect marker, placed at the end of a sentence or after the predicate, indicating that the action has been completed. When placed after the predicate, it must precede the tense marker, such as don‘p and don pot. If the preceding word ends in a plosive sound, the D is silent.

Progressive tense:

Tin /tɪn/ – progressive marker, placed at the end of a sentence or after the predicate, indicating that the action is currently ongoing. When placed after the predicate, it must precede the tense marker, such as tin‘p and tin pot. Cannot coexist with Don.

Past future tense:

Since this tense only appears in contexts where a prediction about a future event is made from the past, Nostal or En nostle is used at the beginning of the sentence to

indicate the past tense, while Fits and its variants are used within the sentence to indicate the future tense (Nokstal cannot be used here).

(4) Person, Possession, and Nouns

Personal pronouns:

La /lɑ/ – I (nominative), Las /lɑs/ – me (accusative), Lat /lɑt/ – my, Lavida /lɑˈviː.dɑ/ – myself

Re /re/ – you (nominative), Res /res/ – you (accusative), Ret /ret/ – your, Revida /reˈviː.dɑ/ – yourself

7a /tɑ/ – she/he (nominative), 7as /tɑs/ – her/him (accusative), 7at /tɑt/ – her/his, 7avida /tɑˈviː.dɑ/ – herself/himself

Qua /kwɑ/ He (nominative), Quathi /kwɑz/ Him (accusative), Quat /kwɑt/ His, Quavida /kwɑˈviː.dɑ/ Himself

Ksa /ksɑ/ It (nominative), Ksathi /ksɑz/ It (accusative), Ksat /ksɑt/ Its, Ksavida /ksɑˈviː.dɑ/ Itself

(5) Nouns

Nouns have no gender distinctions.

Nouns have a genitive form used to modify another noun following it; the modified noun functions as an attributive, indicating possession or association. The genitive is formed by adding the suffix ‘id/ɪd/’ to the end of the noun.

When expressing two or more instances of a noun, the plural form is used, formed by adding the suffix ‘vis/vɪs/’. There are no uncountable nouns.

Nouns can be used in appositive constructions, where multiple nouns are separated by commas and typically represent parallel objects, images, or symbols.

(6) Verbs

Verbs do not have third-person singular forms. Only in the zero person (Qua and its variants) does the divine marker Quksimorite /kw.ksɪ.mo.raɪt/ appear at the beginning of the sentence, followed by a comma.

Stative verbs transform a verb into a state, functioning as subject or object within a sentence and considered non-finite verbs. They are formed by adding the suffix ‘ni9/nɪŋ/’ to the base verb. Once converted into a stative verb, no tense markers are added.

Placing the letter d/d/ before the base verb forms the infinitive, which acts as a non-finite verb, expressing purpose, intention, or result.

Linking and auxiliary verbs:

Lithi /lɪz/ – linking verb, indicating what kind of state something is.

Dathi /Dʌz/ – auxiliary verb, used to introduce questions.

(7) Numerals and Articles

Definite articles:

Ay /eɪ/ – indicates a single object, but emphasizes the singular state of the object; if the following word begins with a vowel, it becomes Ain /eɪŋ/.

Mon /mon/ – indicates a single object, emphasizing quantity as one.

Indefinite articles:

7ha /ðɑ/ – specifies a particular thing.

7has /ðɑs/ – specifies a particular proper noun.

Indefinite articles do not depend on the number of known objects.

Numerals:

Number words:

Zero to nine: Zon /zɔn/, Mon /mon/, Dine /daɪːn/, 7rai /tʰraɪ/, Ult /ʊlt/, Pent /pɛnt/, Heks /hɛks/, Sew̲ /sɛv/, Diet /daɪːɛt/, Nai /naɪ/

Simplified units (used for individual digits): Zo /zɔ/, Mo /mo/, Do /do/, 7ro /tʰro/, Uto /ʊto/, Po /po/, Ho /ho/, So /so/, Dio /diːo/, No /tʰro/

To express numbers ten or greater, write each digit from left to right starting with the

highest place value, connected by single quotation marks, ending with the simplified unit for the ones place. Example: 7rai‘dine’uto /tʰraɪˈdiːnˈʊto/ (325)

Ordinal numerals:

Can function as adjectives, ranked third in adjective priority, and must precede all adjectives except those expressing possession or abstract qualities. Use 7ha + ordinal numeral to specify "the nth." When the number is ten or greater, replace the simplified unit with the corresponding ordinal form.

Zonal /ˈzo.nɑl/, Monal /ˈmo.nɑl/, Dial /ˈdaɪː.ɑl/, Trial /ˈtʰraɪ.ɑl/, Ultrial /ˈʊl.tʰri.ɑl/, Pental /ˈpɛn.tɑl/, Hektal /ˈhɛk.tɑl/, Sewal /ˈsɛw.θɑl/, Detal /ˈde.tɑl/, Ninal /ˈni.nɑl/

(8) Adjectives

In formal written language, adjectives are ordered based on the way an object is observed:

Abstract qualities > Possession > Quantity > Location and direction > Time > Size > Characteristics > Color > Material

Comparative and superlative forms:

‘lop /lɒp/ is the comparative suffix, indicating a stronger degree of the adjective compared to another thing.

‘lep /lep/ is the comparative suffix, indicating a weaker degree of the adjective compared to another thing.

Apo /ˈeɪ.po/ functions as a pronoun in superlative constructions, meaning "all" or "the whole." 7han /ðɑn/ serves as a preposition expressing comparison in superlative syntax. The superlative form is created by adding than apo /ðɑ.neɪ.po/ after the comparative.

(9) Adverbs

Adverbs appear at the end of sentences and are separated by commas. They correspond from left to right with each verb in the sentence, modifying it accordingly. After the last adverb modifying a given verb, de /dʌ/ is added to connect to the next set of adverbs modifying the following verb(s). To express comparatives and superlatives,

adverbs follow the same rules as adjectives for degrees of comparison.

(10) Conjunctions and Prepositions

Prepositional phrases typically follow nouns and (linking) verbs.

Common prepositions:

D /d/ indicates a state, often used before verbs to convert them into infinitive form.

7han /ðɑn/ expresses comparison, commonly used in comparative and superlative constructions.

En /ɪn/ means "in," "within," or "inside" a place or condition.

On9 /ɑŋ/ means "outside," "beyond," or "externally" a place or condition.

Uari /juːærɪ/ means "above," "on the surface," or "at the beginning" of a condition.

Ouri /oʊrɪ/ means "below," "deep within," or "at the end" of a condition.

Fiuthi /fˈiuː z/ means "in front of," "before" a position or condition.

Dius /dˈiuː s/ means "behind," "after" a position or condition.

Senttha /sɛn.tʃɑ/ means "in the middle," "center" of a place or condition, or "within" something.

Nirthi /ˈnɪrz/ means "near," "close to," or "approximately" a condition.

Common conjunctions:

De⊆ /dɛf/ expresses possession or inclusion ("belonging to"), as in "De⊆ B A" (A of B).

Urd /ʊrd/ means "and," connecting clauses or elements; "A urd B" (A and B).

Gok /gɔk/ means "or," linking alternatives; "A, B gok C" (A, B or C).

Rais /raɪs/ indicates choice between two things, with various usages: "Rais A gok B" (either A or B), "Rais A nor B" (not A but B), "Rais nor A B" (neither A nor B).

Kotth /kɔtʃ/ indicates cause, usually connecting sentences; "A, kotth B" (A because B).

Say /seɪ/ means "so," typically connecting sentences and cannot be used with kotth; "A, say B" (A, resulting in B).

Jiwe /dʒaɪw/ means "for" or "in order to," used in the structure "A jiwe B" (A for B).

(11) Negation and Indicators

Affirmative exclamatory indicator: 7ada /ˈtɑ.dɑ/

Negative exclamatory indicator: Nada /ˈnɑ.dɑ/

Affirmative interrogative indicator: Kata /ˈkɑ.tɑ/

Negative interrogative indicator: Bata /ˈbɑ.tɑ/

Negation marker: Nor /nɔr/, placed before a verb to indicate that the action did not occur.

Passive marker: Ned /nɛd/

(12) Clauses

Clauses are divided into adverbial clauses and general clauses, functioning as sentence components. A brief pause is required to distinguish clauses from regular sentence elements—specifically, a short "7hia /ˈθɪ.jɑ/" is inserted at the beginning of the clause to signal its start. Words within the clause must be connected with hyphens (-).

If a clause modifies a verb, it follows the same rule as adverbs and is placed at the end of the sentence, corresponding to each verb from left to right.

If serving as an attributive or modifying the subject, it immediately follows the word being modified.

If acting as an object, it follows the same rules as objects.

Clauses cannot be nested within other clauses.